

Date: August 5, 2026

RECOMMENDATION LETTER — PEER TUTORING PROGRAM

Dear Peer Tutoring Coordinator:

I am pleased to write this letter in very strong support of Mr. Michael Tan (Student ID: 202101007) who is applying to serve as a peer tutor under the Acadia platform. Mr. Tan completed four subjects under my instruction — Programming Fundamentals (CC-PROG11), Data Structures and Algorithms (CC-DSTRUC21), Software Engineering (CC-SOFENG31), and Information Security (CC-INFOSEC32) — achieving perfect scores in all major examinations across all four courses.

Mr. Tan's programming skills in Java and Python are at a professional level. His understanding of object-oriented design, algorithm complexity analysis, software development lifecycle, and cybersecurity fundamentals surpasses what is expected of an undergraduate student. He has independently developed tools used by our laboratory for automated code grading, demonstrating both technical depth and initiative.

The qualities that distinguish him as a peer tutor are:

- Critical Thinking — He analyzes problems from multiple angles and guides students toward solutions rather than simply providing answers.
- Communication — He frames technical concepts in accessible language adapted to his listener.
- Patience — He never shows frustration and repeats explanations as many times as needed.
- Leadership — He organized weekly peer study sessions for his entire section throughout the semester.
- Dedication — He invests personal time in helping peers without any expectation of reward.
- Problem Solving — He breaks down complex algorithms and debugging challenges into clear, manageable steps.

I have been teaching at the tertiary level for more than twelve years and I can say without hesitation that Mr. Michael Tan is among the most exceptional students I have ever encountered. Any student who has the opportunity to be tutored by him will benefit enormously.

I give Mr. Michael Tan my sincerest, strongest, and most enthusiastic endorsement for the Acadia Peer Tutoring Program for all four of the above-mentioned subjects.

Respectfully,

Dr. Fernando C. Castillo, PhD

Associate Professor IV
Department of Computer Science and IT
University of San Carlos

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This letter has been validated by the Office of the Dean, School of Engineering and Architecture.